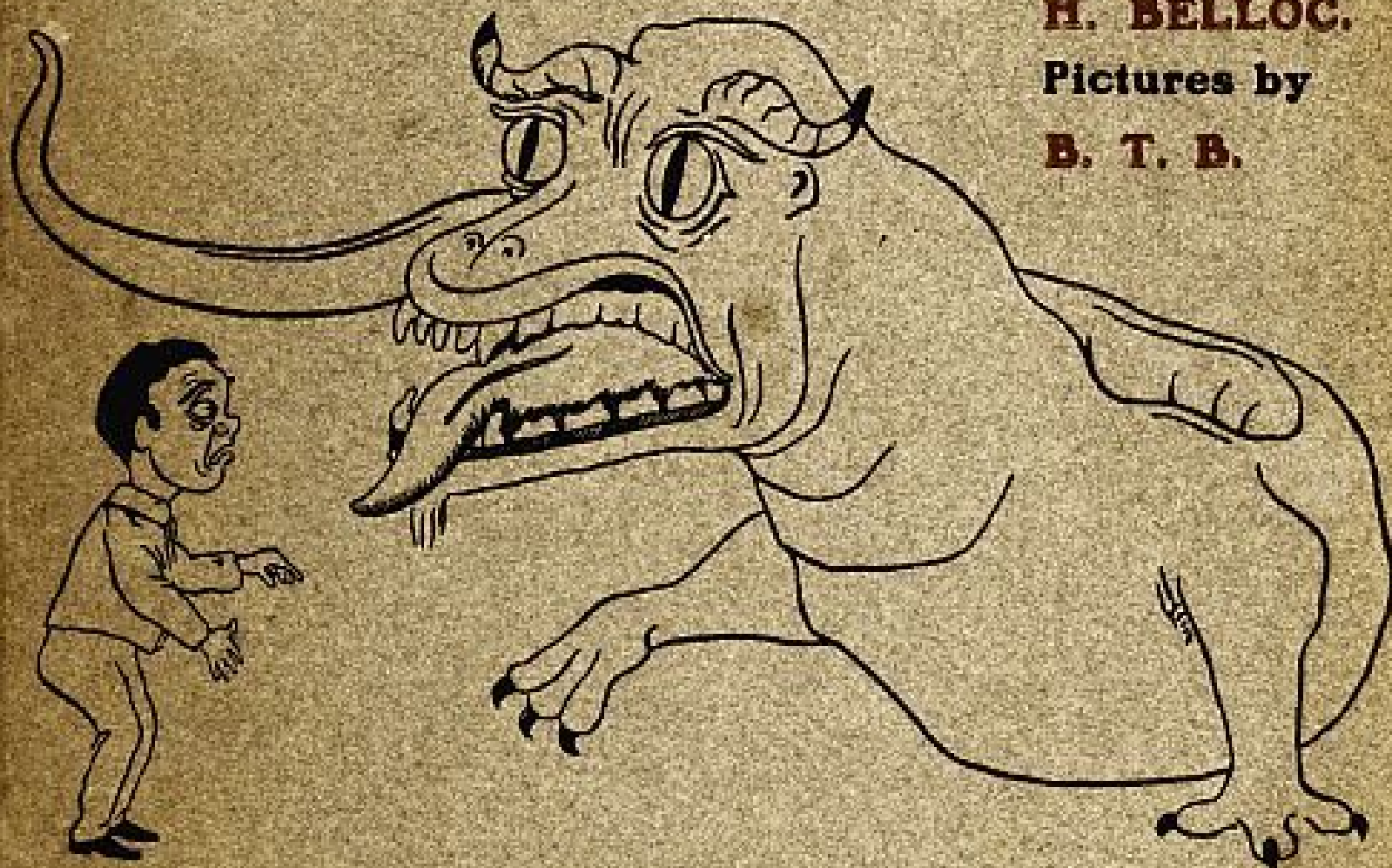


MORE BEASTS FOR WORSE CHILDREN

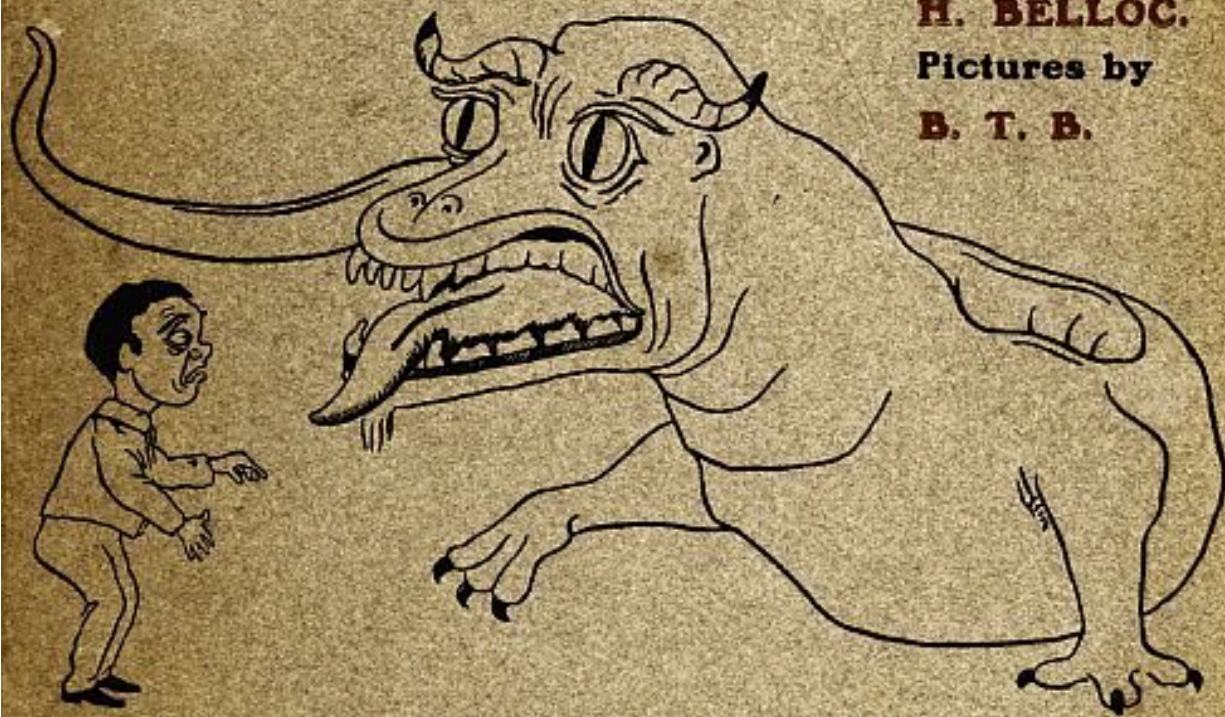
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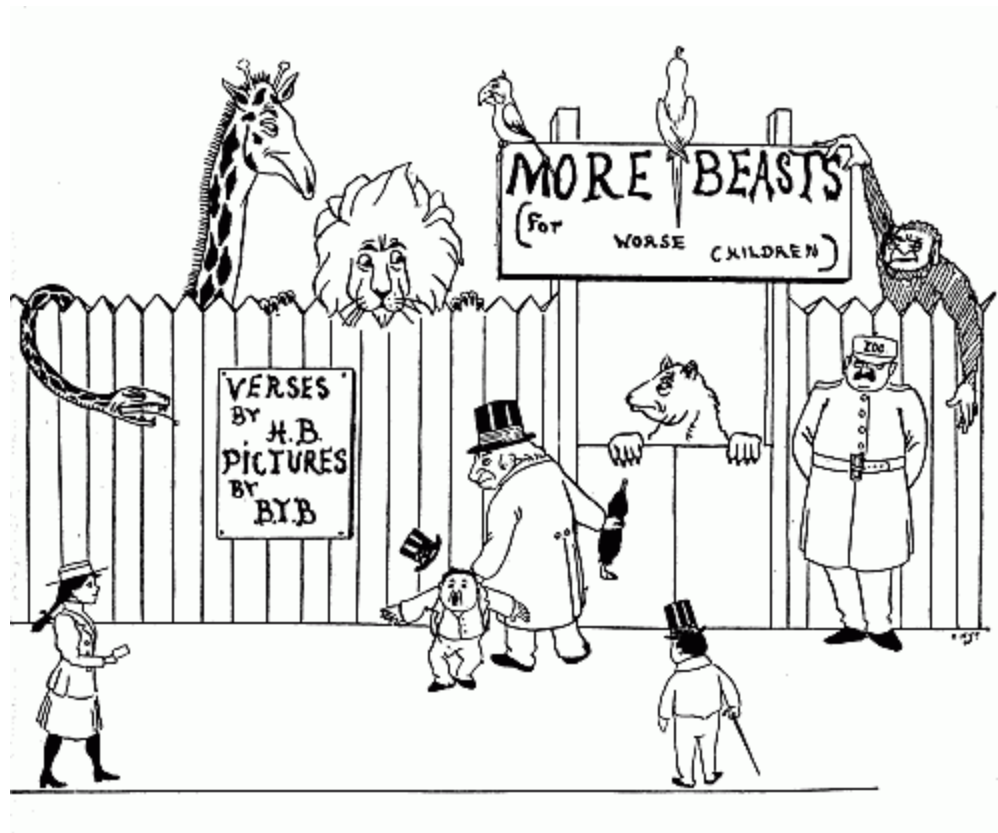
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MORE BEASTS

(For WORSE CHILDREN)

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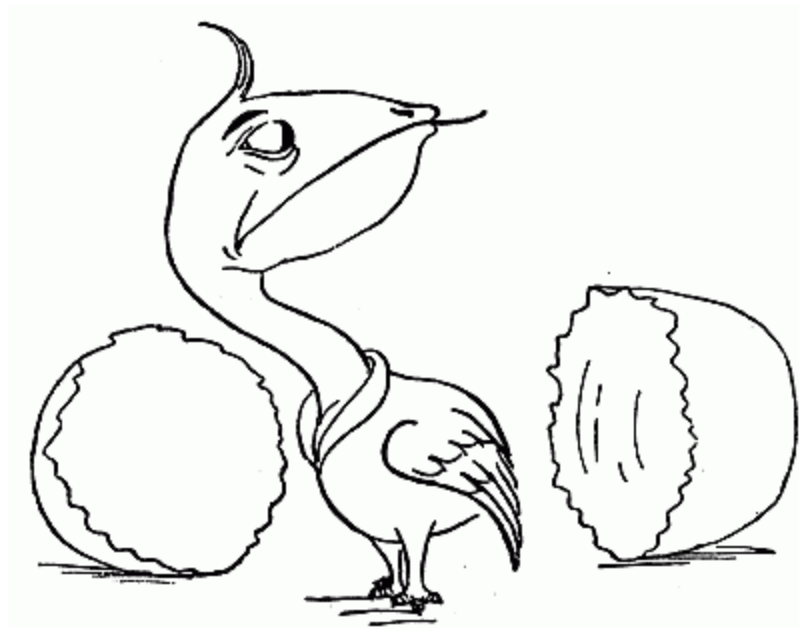
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—♦♦—
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Miss ALICE WOLCOTT BRINLEY,
Of Philadelphia.



MORE BEASTS

FOR WORSE CHILDREN

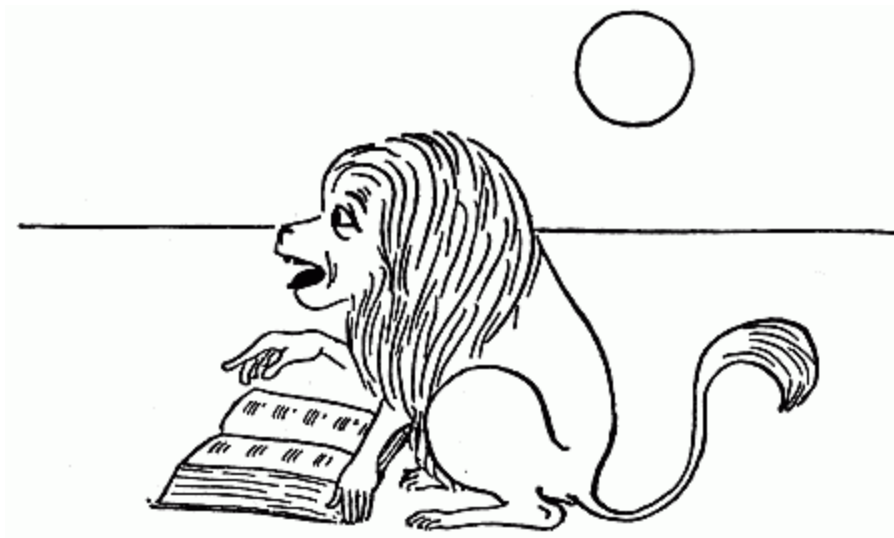
INTRODUCTION

The parents of the learned child
 (His father and his mother)
Were utterly aghast to note
The facts he would at random quote
On creatures curious, rare and wild;
 And wondering, asked each other:



"An idle little child like this,
 How is it that he knows
What years of close analysis
 Are powerless to disclose?

Our brains are trained, our books are big,
 And yet we always fail

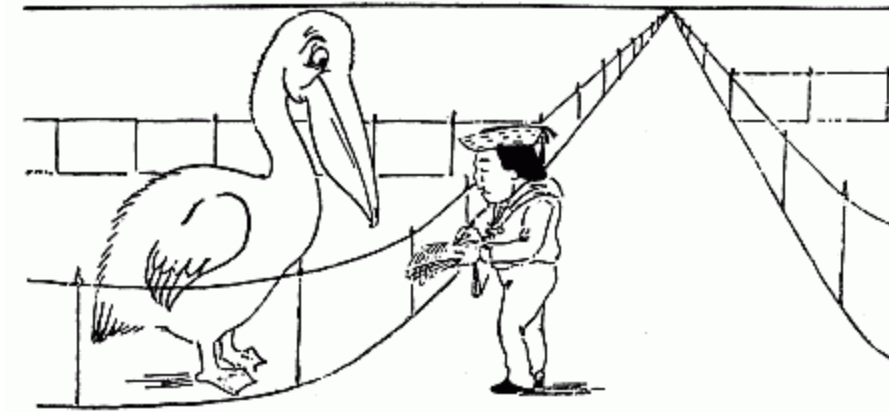


To answer why the Guinea-pig
Is born without a tail.

Or why the Wanderoo[A] should rant
In wild, unmeaning rhymes,



Whereas the Indian Elephant
Will only read *The Times*.



Perhaps he found a way to slip
Unnoticed to the Zoo,
And gave the Pachyderm a tip,
Or pumped the Wanderoo.

Or even by an artful plan
Deceived our watchful eyes,
And interviewed the Pelican,
Who is extremely wise."



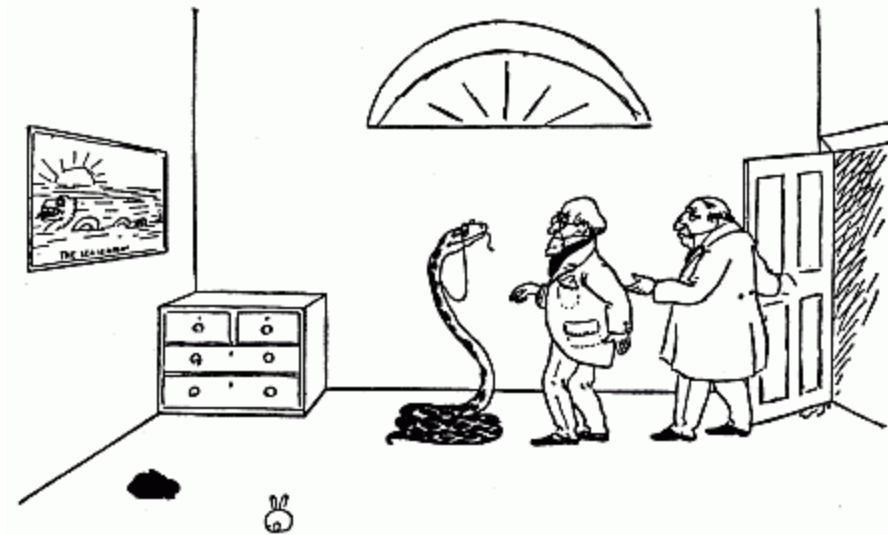
"Oh! no," said he, in humble tone,
With shy but conscious look,
"Such facts I never could have known
But for this little book."

FOOTNOTE:

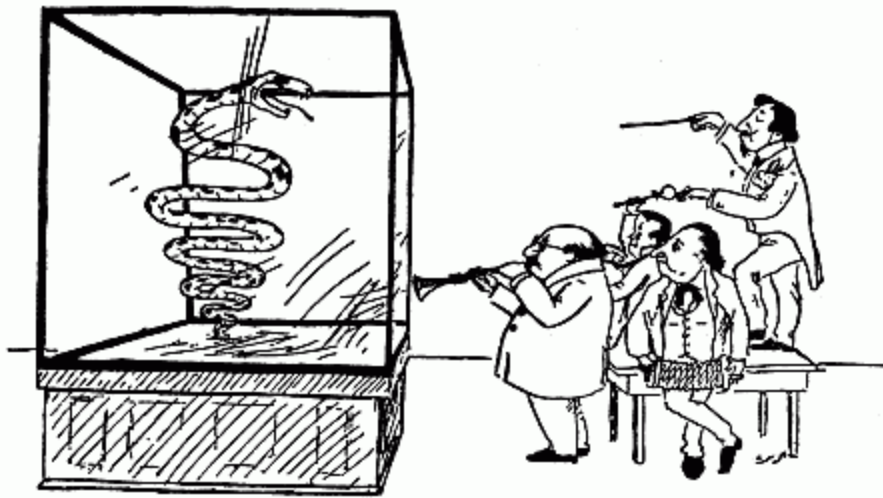
[\[A\]](#) Sometimes called the "Lion-tailed or tufted Baboon of Ceylon."



The Python



A Python I should not advise,—
It needs a doctor for its eyes,
And has the measles yearly.



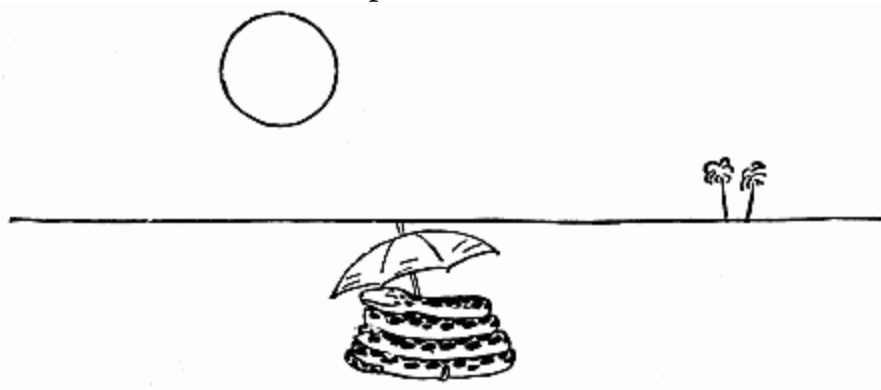
However, if you feel inclined
To get one (to improve your mind,
And not from fashion merely),
Allow no music near its cage;



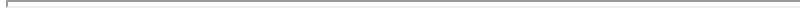
And when it flies into a rage
Chastise it, most severely.



I had an aunt in Yucatan
Who bought a Python from a man
And kept it for a pet.
She died, because she never knew
These simple little rules and few;—



The Snake is living yet.

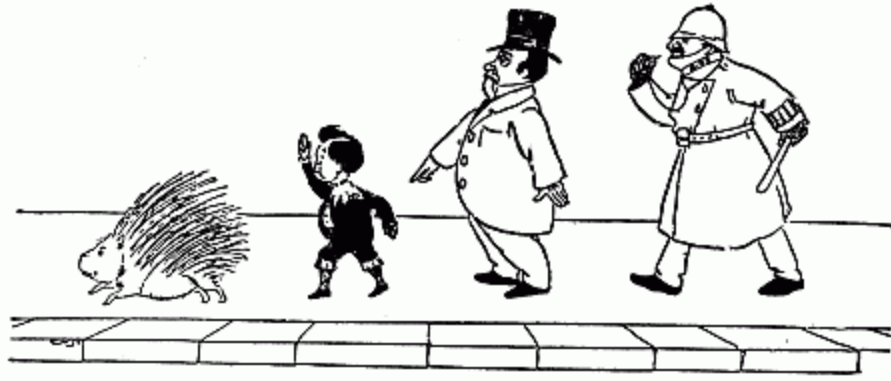


The Welsh Mutton



The Cambrian Welsh or Mountain Sheep
Is of the Ovine race,
His conversation is not deep,
But then—observe his face!

The Porcupine



What! would you slap the Porcupine?
Unhappy child—desist!
Alas! that any friend of mine
Should turn Tupto-philist.[\[B\]](#)



To strike the meanest and the least
Of creatures is a sin,



How much more bad to beat a beast
With prickles on its skin.

FOOTNOTE:

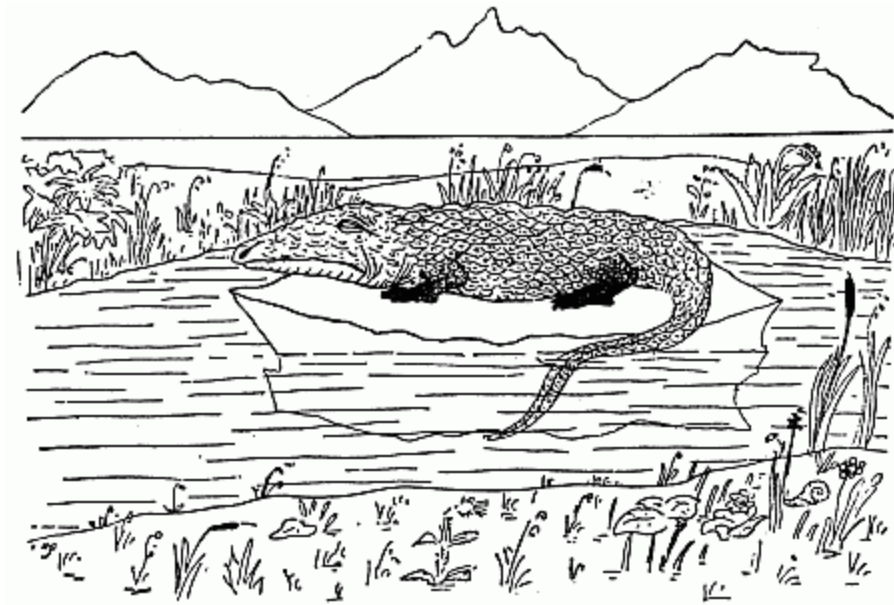
[B] From τυπτω=I strike; φιλεω=I love; one that loves to strike. The word is not found in classical Greek, nor does it occur among the writers of the Renaissance—nor anywhere else.

The Scorpion

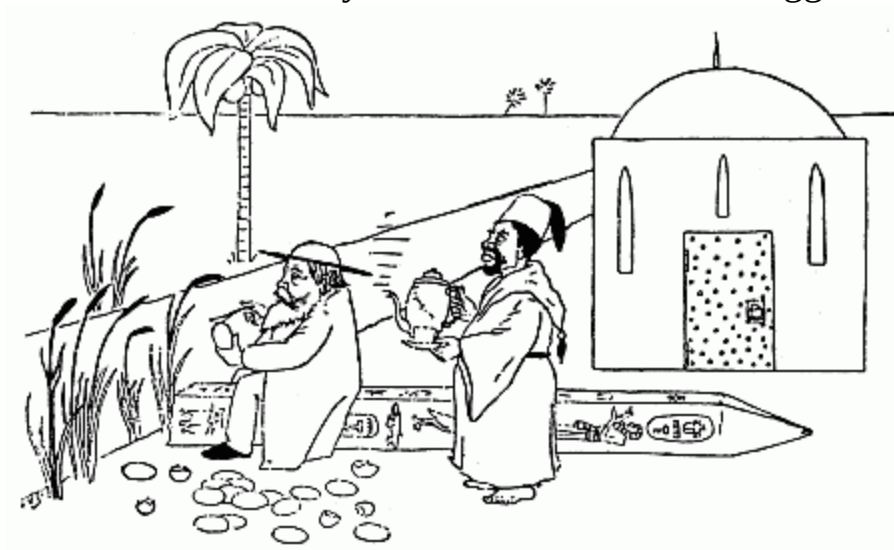


The Scorpion is as black as soot,
He dearly loves to bite;
He is a most unpleasant brute
To find in bed, at night.

The Crocodile



Whatever our faults, we can always engage
That no fancy or fable shall sully our page,
So take note of what follows, I beg.
This creature so grand and august in its age,
In its youth is hatched out of an egg.

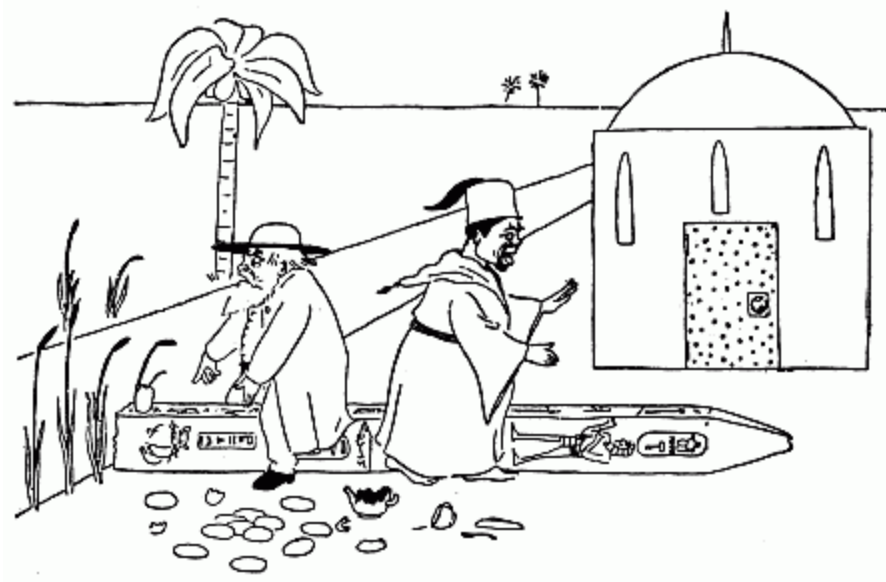


And oft in some far Coptic town
The Missionary sits him down

To breakfast by the Nile:
The heart beneath his priestly gown
Is innocent of guile;



When suddenly the rigid frown
Of Panic is observed to drown
His customary smile.



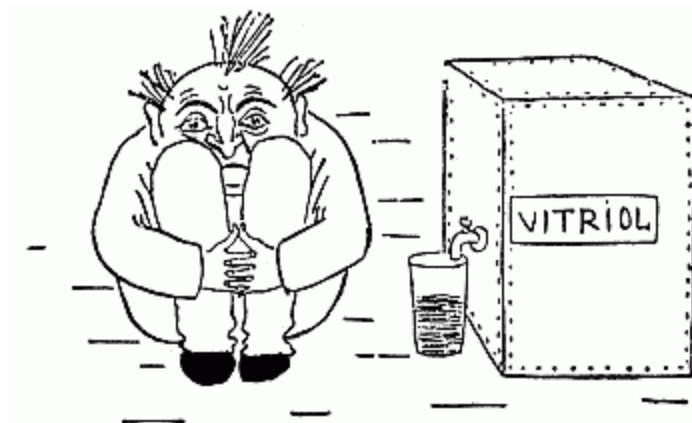
Why does he start and leap amain,



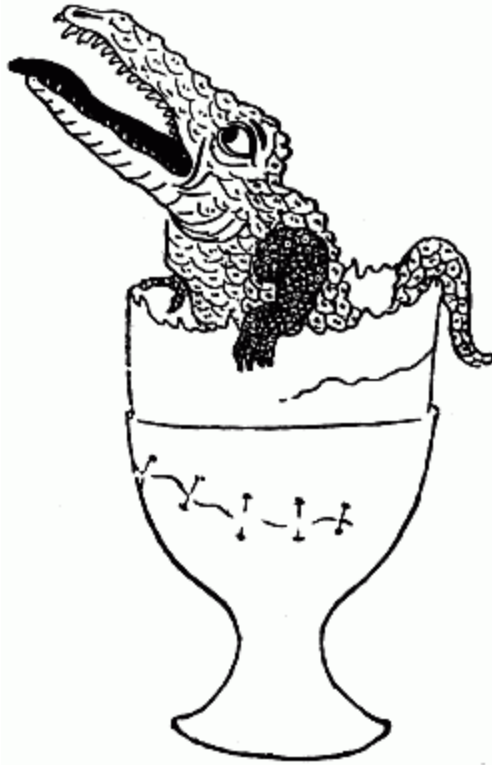
And scour the sandy Libyan plain



Like one that wants to catch a train,

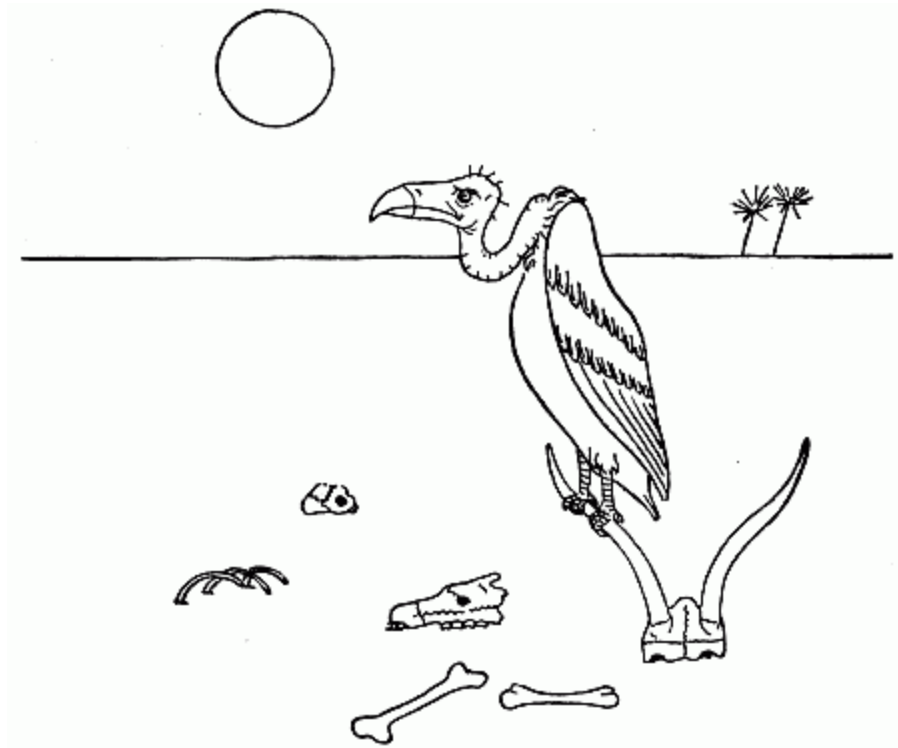


Or wrestles with internal pain?



Because he finds his egg contain—
Green, hungry, horrible and plain—
An Infant Crocodile.

The Vulture



The Vulture eats between his meals,
And that's the reason why



He very, very rarely feels
As well as you and I.

His eye is dull, his head is bald,
His neck is growing thinner.
Oh! what a lesson for us all
To only eat at dinner!

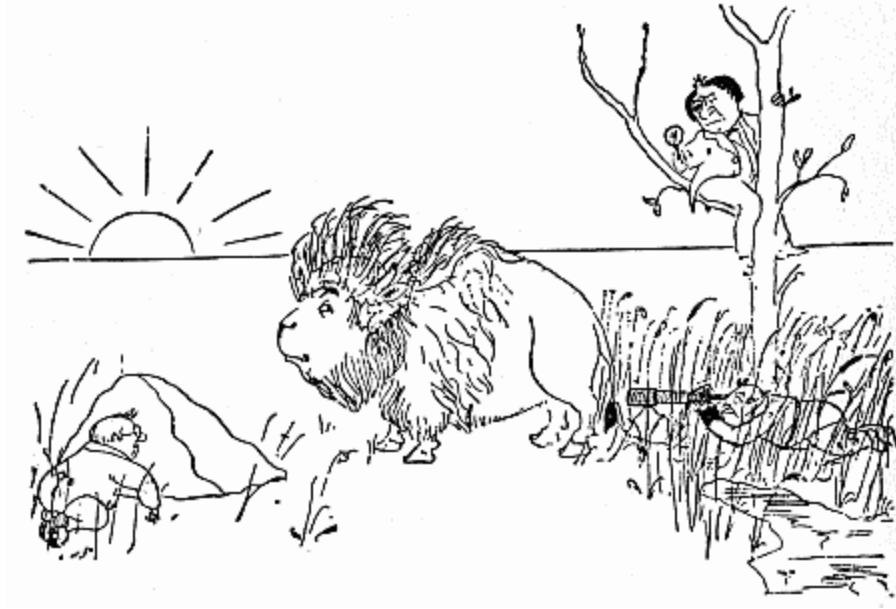
The Bison



The Bison is vain, and (I write it with pain)
The Door-mat you see on his head

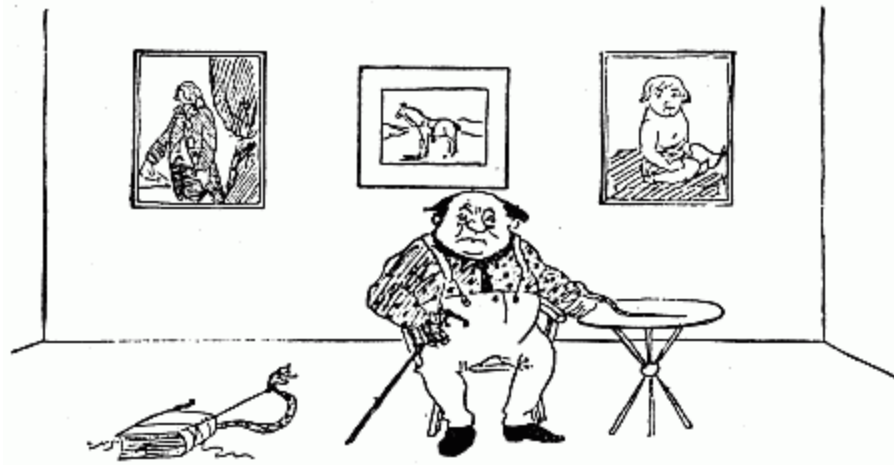


Is not, as some learned professors maintain,
The opulent growth of a genius' brain;



But is sewn on with needle and thread.

The Viper

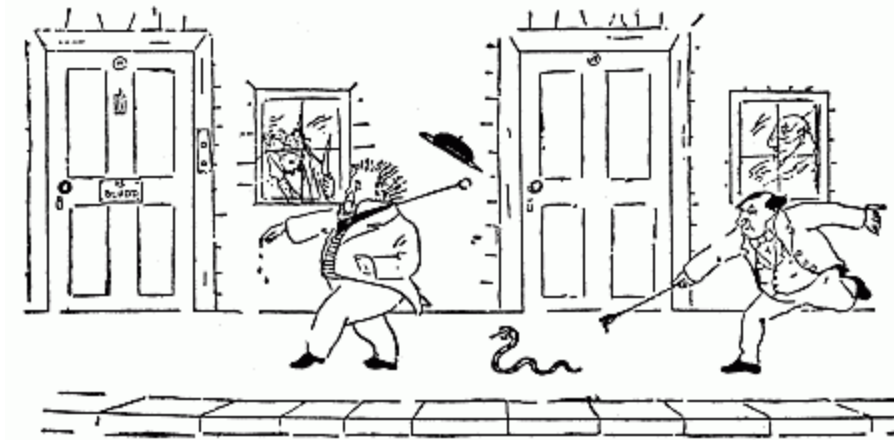


Yet another great truth I record in my verse,
That some Vipers are venomous, some the
reverse;

A fact you may prove if you try,



By procuring two Vipers, and letting them
bite;

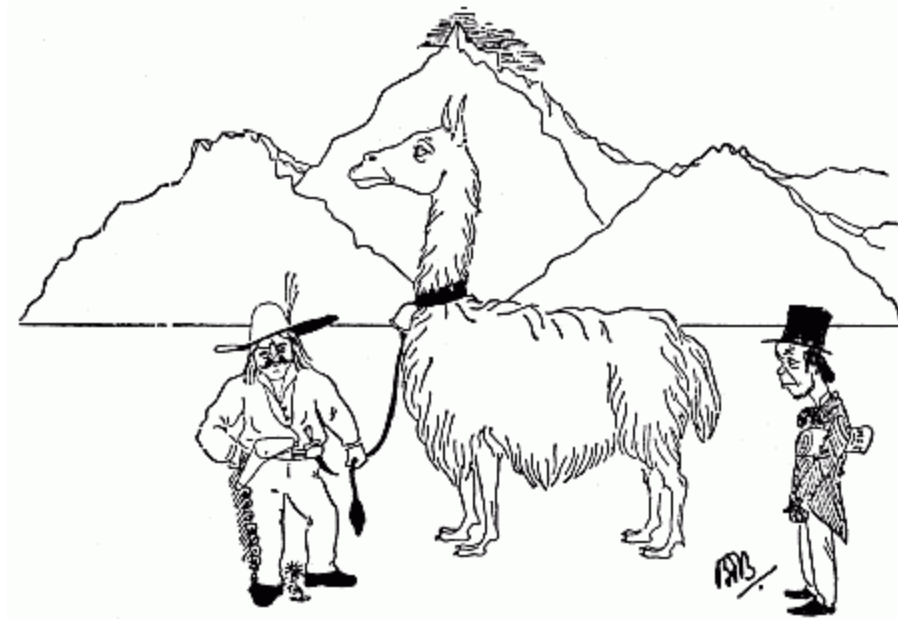


With the *first* you are only the worse for a fright,



But after the *second* you die.

The Llama



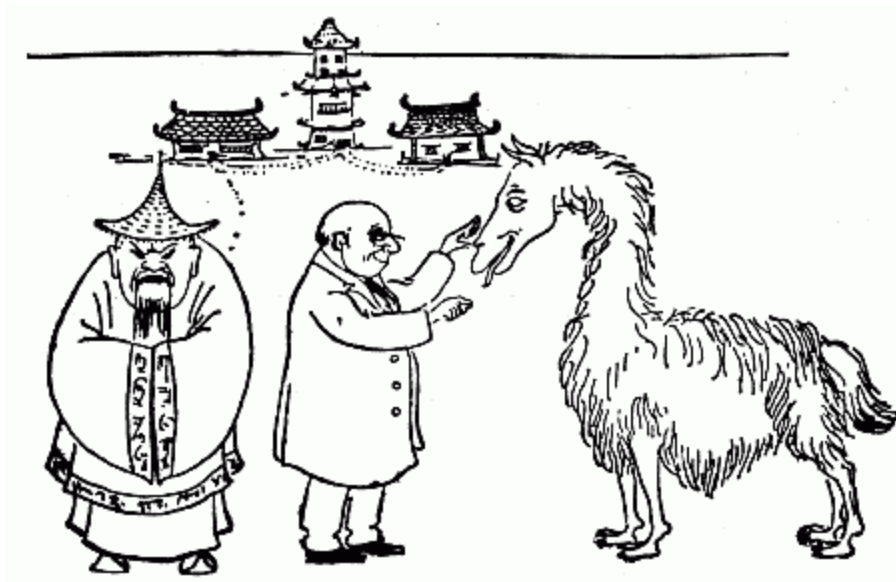
The Llama is a woolly sort of fleecy hairy
goat,
With an indolent expression and an
undulating throat
Like an unsuccessful literary man.



And I know the place he lives in (or at least
 —I think I do)
 It is Ecuador, Brazil or Chili—possibly Peru;
 You must find it in the Atlas if you
 can.



The Llama of the Pampasses you never
should confound
(In spite of a deceptive similarity of sound)
With the Lhama who is Lord of
Turkestan.



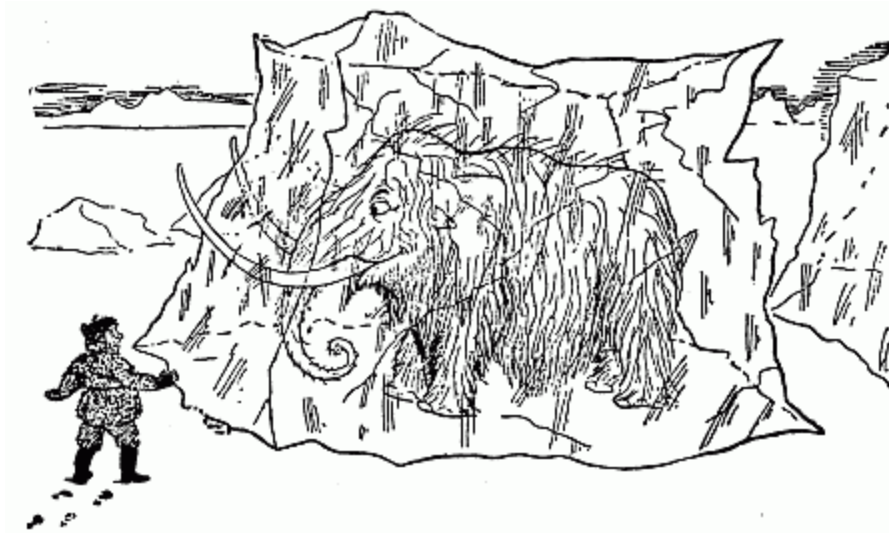
For the former is a beautiful and valuable
beast,
But the latter is not lovable nor useful in the
least;
And the Ruminant is preferable surely to the
Priest
Who battens on the woful superstitions of the
East,
The Mongol of the Monastery of Shan.

The Chamois



The Chamois inhabits
Lucerne, where his habits
 (Though why I have not an idea-r)
Give him sudden short spasms
On the brink of deep chasms,
 And he lives in perpetual fear.

The Frozen Mammoth



This Creature, though rare, is still found to
the East
Of the Northern Siberian Zone.



It is known to the whole of that primitive
group
That the carcass will furnish an excellent
soup,

Though the cooking it offers one
drawback at least

(Of a serious nature I own):



If the skin be *but punctured* before it is
boiled,
Your confection is wholly and utterly spoiled.

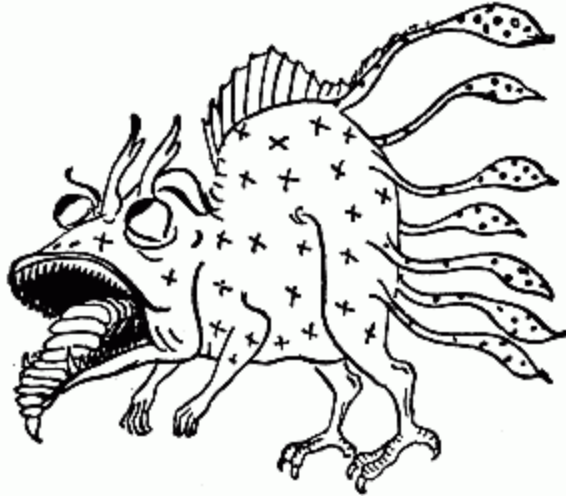


And hence (on account of the size of the
beast)
The dainty is nearly unknown.

The Microbe



The Microbe is so very small
You cannot make him out at all,
But many sanguine people hope
To see him through a microscope.
His jointed tongue that lies beneath
A hundred curious rows of teeth;
His seven tufted tails with lots
Of lovely pink and purple spots,



On each of which a pattern stands,
Composed of forty separate bands;
His eyebrows of a tender green;
All these have never yet been seen—
But Scientists, who ought to know,
Assure us that they must be so. . . .
Oh! let us never, never doubt
What nobody is sure about!



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